



LISTENING

#12

1 - In this activity, you will practice listening for information about SMART goals. Then, you will discuss your own ideas about how to use SMART goals in daily life, at school, and for personal growth.

S.M.A.R.T GOALS

1 - What do you think of the SMART goals?

2 - True or False:

A SMART goal is a goal that is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.

3 - What would you consider a behavioral SMART goal or an academic SMART goal?

4 - Do you need to follow the SMART goals in order, or can you alternate between the letters?

5 - What would you consider a specific goal?

6 - What do you think of time-bound goals?

7 - How can you decide if a goal is relevant to you?

8 - Which type of goal allows you to see the changes you are striving for?

9 - What do you think of realistic and achievable goals?

10 - Do you think that using SMART goals helps you achieve your goals?

SMART GOALS

Goals are essential in life and business because they provide focus, motivation, and direction. To increase the chances of success, the SMART framework is used. SMART is an acronym for Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic, and Timely. A SMART goal combines these five elements to create clarity and urgency.

Specific goals are clear and well defined. To make them specific, it is useful to ask the five “W” questions: *Who is involved? What do I want to accomplish? Where will this happen? When do I want it? Why is it important?* For example, instead of saying “I want to get in shape,” a specific goal would be “I want to join the local gym and work out four days a week.”

Measurable goals include criteria to track progress. Without measurement, it is impossible to know if the goal is being reached. Key questions are: *How much? How many? How will I know when it is accomplished?* Building on the fitness example, one might say, “I will aim to lose one pound of fat per week.”

Achievable goals must be realistic enough to be attainable but still challenging. The focus is on whether resources, skills, or support are available. Questions include: *Do I have the resources? Have others achieved this before?*

Realistic goals are within reach given the time, effort, and resources available. They must be aligned with one’s life purpose or business needs. Questions are: *Is this goal realistic? Can I commit to it?*

Timely goals require a clear deadline. A defined start and end date creates urgency and accountability. For instance: “On August 1, I will start working out four days a week. By the end of August, I aim to lose four pounds.”

The importance of SMART goals lies in avoiding vague and unrealistic objectives such as “I want to be the best.” Such statements lack clarity and direction. SMART goals, in contrast, provide structure, focus, and measurable results.

By applying the SMART method, individuals and organizations can organize their efforts more effectively, stay motivated, and achieve concrete outcomes. This method transforms abstract intentions into actionable steps that lead to success.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 – How does the SMART framework transform vague intentions into actionable outcomes, and why is this transformation essential for success?

2 – In what ways do the five “W” questions enhance the specificity of a goal, and how does this differ from general statements like “I want to be the best”?

3 – Why is the element of “Timely” considered crucial in the SMART method, and how does it influence motivation and accountability compared to goals without deadlines?
